Young People Can Make a Difference

STEP 1 RAISING AWARENESS

1 A Think about something in your school, your community or the world that you would like to change. Write it on a sticky note and put it on your classroom wall.

B Read your classmates' notes from Ex 1A and answer the questions.

1 Are there any common patterns or shared issues?

2 Is there anything that surprises you or that you haven't thought about before?

C Work in in pairs or small groups and discuss the questions.

1 Do you think people under 18 can make a real impact on society? Explain your ideas.

2 What skills/qualities/activities can help young people to make their voices heard?

STEP 2 GOING AHEAD

2 A Make a note of what you know about Greta Thunberg and Fridays for Future.

B Work in pairs and compare your ideas. Have either of you ever joined a Fridays for Future initiative?

C Read the interview. Look at your answers to Ex 2A and check your ideas.

D Read the interview again and choose the correct option (a, b or c).

1 Susie

a founded the Climate Movement in the UK.

b has only recently joined the Climate Movement.

c will soon join the Climate Movement.

2 Susie thinks the environment

a needs everyone's active engagement.

b is better protected in some areas of the world.

c should be given more importance in Science courses.

3 If we want to stop climate change now,

a more people should join Fridays for Future.

b new laws should be adopted.

c we should adopt a new lifestyle.

4 Important changes in society are possible if

a men and women have the same rights.

b young people are involved in decision-making processes.

c education is available for everyone.



Global Climate Strike

Why I strike: Fridays for Future

Let's meet Susie, a young high school student from Sheffield, UK, who has been involved in the Climate Movement for a month now.

Q Susie, can you tell us something about yourself?

A I'm a 17-year-old student and I have always been interested in the natural world and the future of the planet. I like Biology and Geography at school. I would like to become a scientist working to help the environment. I want to be an environmental activist and work together with other people for a better world.

Q Why did you decide to join this movement?

A I was excited to discover that there is an organisation for young people like me who want to protect the environment. I joined Fridays for Future last month because I want to be involved in helping to find a solution to environmental problems.

Q What would you like to say to other young people?

A We are all part of the problem and we must all be part of the solution. We need to take urgent action and start changing the way we live our lives. We have to do this right now because there are people and places that are feeling the effects of climate change. Remember: we have to act right now!

Q Who is your role model?

A We have plenty of role models to choose from, and I admire them all. I admire Greta Thunberg, who does so much to make people aware of climate problems. I also admire Malala Yousafzai, who is an activist for girls' rights in Pakistan. She talks about the importance of education for everyone, and I agree. Education is an essential part of any movement.

Q Do you have a motto or a slogan that you want to share?

A You cannot respect something without loving it, and you cannot love something you do not know.

PHOTOCOPIABLE © Pearson Education Limited 2023

3 **How much do you agree with the following statements made by Susie?**

	I strongly agree.	I agree.	I partially agree.	I disagree.
I have always been interested in the future of the planet.				
I want to be an environmental activist and work for a better world.				
We are all part of the problem and we must all be part of the solution.				
Education is an essential part of any movement.				
You cannot respect something without loving it, and you cannot love something you do not know.				

Language for citizenship

4 **Complete the sentences with the words in the box.**

activist	campaign	movement
organisation	involved	scientists

1 _____ are warning about the effects global warming will have on us.

2 Ali is a climate _____ in his country. Through his youth _____, he urges young people to take part in their country's climate _____.

3 'Be Seen Be Heard' is a UN _____ which intends to promote youth participation and amplify young voices in public life.

4 Why are young people seldom _____ in decision-making processes that directly affect them?



CRITICAL THINKING

The Italian Constitution

5 **Read Article 3 of the Italian Constitution and answer the question.**

According to the Constitution, what is needed for all citizens to actively participate in public life?

- personal ideas ☐
- freedom and equality ☐
- political parties ☐
- social conditions ☐

Tutti i cittadini hanno pari dignità sociale e sono eguali davanti alla legge, senza distinzione di sesso, di razza, di lingua, di religione, di opinioni politiche, di condizioni personali e sociali. È compito della Repubblica rimuovere gli ostacoli di ordine economico e sociale, che, limitando di fatto la libertà e l'eguaglianza dei cittadini, impediscono il pieno sviluppo della persona umana e l'effettiva partecipazione di tutti i lavoratori all'organizzazione politica, economica e sociale del Paese.

STEP 3 TAKING ACTION

Digital literacies

6 **Work in groups of three or four. Choose one of the following activities.**

1 Youth-led movements

Go online and find information about some important episodes or events in a youth-led movement of your own choice. Live tweet the events of the movement from the perspective of a student.

2 Environmental activism

Do some research on an environmental activist or organisation. Create a poster or a slideshow presentation to summarise your findings. Include this information:

- What is the name of the activist/organisation?
- What actions has the activist/organisation implemented to bring about change?
- How effective are the activist's/organisation's actions?
- Where is the activist/organisation trying to effect change? Globally? Nationally? Locally?
- How can I get involved? Where do I find more information?

PHOTOCOPIABLE © Pearson Education Limited 2023